Chapter 17: Get Robbed. Get Framed.

Battle day was only two days away, and Catria went to bed in her room in her province nervous about it. She and Erik had returned to Terrian, and she went home to make final plans for their wedding. Yet, everything wasn't perfect. The shot the week before at Erik had her terrified. How had any shot gone through a war mage's shielding? That wasn't supposed to be able to happen. Yet, it had, perhaps by a faeborn. Some of them had terrifying abilities, and many were mischievous. There was a reason many people were afraid of them.

Still, it didn't help Catria to not sleep. It was less than two weeks away from her wedding. Soon, she'd have Erik there at night with her, so she's sleep safely. He was so protective and so perfect. She was so fortunate to have had him fall for her.

Yet, they were both a target. Someone was trying to kill Erik. That was obvious. What if the faeborn who could get past the shielding succeeded? No, he wouldn't.

She'd be there with him. She could heal him from anything. After all, her healing power was stronger the more she connected with someone, and she really connected with Erik. After the wedding, they'd connect even more. She blushed at the thought.

She put her hand on the pewter necklace he'd give her that was around her neck. Touching it gave her some security.

She finally did go to sleep to thoughts of Erik and having him there beside her. Soon they would be married, and she'd feel safe at night.

She was right not to feel safe. Two hours after she fell asleep the door to her room opened slowly, and a man suddenly appeared, a short, stocky man with auburn hair all over, and rather unkempt on his head. He wore green, and nimbly rubbed his fingers together.

Despite his stocky appearance, he very nimbly and silently moved around the room. Catria didn't seem to have much that was expensive or particularly noteworthy. He picked the lock on the chest at the foot of her bed and looked through it. There were important papers and a few books, but apparently, she kept most of her belongings at the war mage headquarters.

The thief looked around and crept quietly over to Catria. He looked at her face. It wasn't bad for a full human lady, but she was quite tall, particularly compared to him. He gently moved her hair and noticed the pewter necklace around her neck. That would work.

Without her feeling at thing, her removed the necklace and put it in a pouch on his belt.

He then walked out of the room. The chest was open and the items I it ruffled, but he didn't care. He had what he came for.

He ran through the trees, not making a sound. A mile away, he had a horse and wagon. When he reached it, he hopped in and headed to his next target. It would take a few hours to get there, but that was fine. He was wide awake at night and saw perfectly in the darkness.

He reached Aschelle early the next morning and took a quick nap in a tree.

He didn't get up until market opened. When it did, he went invisible, joined a crowd, and went to a table many people were looking at goods at.

There was a small box of saffron, a very expensive spice, so he thought of stealing it, but then he saw something that gave him a better idea.

Several Achellean war mages were walking down the street.

People bowed to them as they passed.

The faeborn walked toward the team, bumped Freya Flashdaggers and stole a dagger from her boot. As he did, he dropped the necklace he'd stolen.

At first, Freya didn't notice she'd been robbed, so the faeborn called, "What's that?"

Freya looked down. When she did, she saw the

necklace and noticed the dagger was stolen from her boot.

The faeborn smiled. His task was complete, and Slayde would pay him well… except… There was one more detail to take care of.

Later that night, he entered a tavern that Freya and Quex were at. Freya was still fuming about being robbed and swearing vengeance on whoever the necklace belonged to.

The faeborn walked over to the table Quex and Freya were at and announced, “I’m Calix. You should know me from the arena. I have information for sale.”

Aschelleans did not want to be seen with faeborn, but often dealt with them. Ques responded, “Meet us in the back room.”

They did all meet in the back room, where Calix held his hand out and explained, “I know who the necklace belongs to, and you will find it interesting.”

Quex did pay Calix, so Calix explained, “It belongs to Catria.”

Freya’s eyes went wide. “Catria robbed me! I will kill her in the arena.”

Quex chuckled. “I didn’t see her.” He glared at Calix. “Is this a set up?”

“Does it matter?” Calix asked.

“No,” Quex agreed. “Either way, we have an excuse to kill Catria, and we want her dead.”